

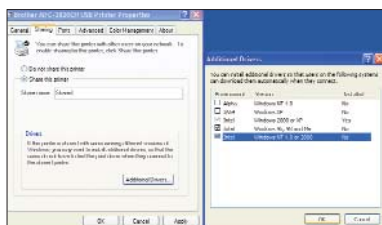
Installing additional drivers

If you are sharing your printer over a local area network (LAN), you probably want all users, running any version of Windows, to be able to use it, right? If you are running Windows 2000 or XP, you should install additional drivers, so that Windows 98 users don't have to look for drivers to use your printer.

Go to **Control Panel > Printers**, right-click on the printer icon and choose Properties. In the Sharing tab, click on the 'Additional Drivers...' button.

Now you need to select each operating system's drivers. For example, if your host OS is Windows

XP, and you wish to share the printer for Windows 98 and Me machines then select Windows 98/Me. now all you need to do is insert the driver CD and wait for the installation to finish. You might have to select the exact path for each additional operating system that you selected. Once done, anyone running any of the OSes that you installed drivers for, can just double-click on the printer to install it. Do this by going opening Network Neighborhood, browse to the computer connected to the printer and double click on it.



Select the various Windows versions that you want to install drivers for, and click OK



Buying Tips

- Opt for a printer with a USB interface, which offers higher data transfer speeds. There is nothing like a printer offering both USB and parallel connectivity.
- Consider the total cost of ownership (TCO), not just the price. Vendors tend to sell printers dirt-cheap. Prices of cartridges, though, are skyrocketing. If you have tons to print, even a minor difference in the cost per page will save you a lot over the printer's lifetime.
- Check whether the printer supports extra features such as ink status determination via software, so that you can be sure of when to change the cartridge.
- Inkjets that use pigment-based inks are better than those using normal dye-based inks. Printouts taken with the former are smudge-proof, water-resistant and last longer.
- Choose a printer based on the kind of print quality you actually require. Inkjet printers offer excellent quality as far as images and graphics are concerned,

whereas laser printers offer better quality text printouts.

- If you're planning to buy an inkjet printer, make sure to check the page per minute (ppm) speed. Manufacturer-rated speeds are always in accordance with the printer's fastest mode of printing, and you're more likely to be printing in Normal or Best mode, which is much slower.
- If you intend to share the printer over a network, or print heavy images, look for one with higher buffer memory.
- If you are buying a printer for photo printouts, always take a test print to check for quality. Some printers require a separate ink cartridge for photo quality printouts, while some don't. Check for this, as it affects the TCO.
- Check the manufacturer's Web site for the type of support they offer, whether they offer regular software updates or patches for new operating systems.





Picasso

The i255 comes in a cube-inspired form, with gently rounded corners and a choice of two colours: white and dark grey.

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